



T h e
C r a b

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“For if there is a sin against life, it consists perhaps not so much in despairing of life as in hoping for another life and eluding the implacable grandeur of this life.”

— Albert Camus, *The Myth of Sisyphus*

THE CRAB

YESTERDAY morning I hit my head on the dresser, today it's my foot. I've heard enough about the need to keep going, to keep going. I've long referred to myself as a stone, impenetrable, stiff, unmoving, unevolving, here, here.

I was at church. For the first time in years, and for the life of me I wasn't going to allow God to make a fool of me, to make me cry? In front of these strangers? Moved beyond control? No. No, this is all I have, I keep my elements together always—an immaculate strength, an invisible strength to keep this all up.

And yes I told God, and I said, I'm a stone, this is how it has to be, I'm sorry.

How do you think I got through it all? How do you think I'll get through it all to come? Yes, one by one I've had to close my entry points, I've had to shut down, light by light until the tower went completely black.

Still so loud on the inside, still a call from the basement, but
on the outside I'm all put together, one gleaming hard surface.
A mesmerising sheet of gold, it attracts, it gets stares, men try
me, this gleaming surface of mine. Oh to take it for a spin, to
take it for a spin. It took a lot to become this metal.

Still clawing through life so slowly it seems, really I'm a crab of
a woman. Yes, a sharp, crawling, helpless crab.

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So now what's love to a crab? A crab like me? With pincers like mine? Love will destroy me, I've seen it play out, and you've heard the stories.

So am I wrong for the steps I take, the steps I won't take? Love will not make me budge. I see right through it all. I will sit right here, the air is good, the light is fine and I've grown fond of the dust I seem to collect.

What I lack, my imagination gives tenfold! Married in Paris! Yes, children running around at Christmas! Money coming out of my ears! A hot man on my tongue.

You see, a self-sufficient ecosystem of a life, look at the form of me. I'm all in one. I lack nothing, I have everything.

How could anyone get to my root? Under cement soil they
can't steal it, they can't chew it. I am all defence! I laugh when
they seek me out, I know a few tricks!

Disappear, reappear, a sleight of hand here, a sleight of hand
there. They want to warm me up, gradually turn the heat up on
me. But listen, when a storm comes, these silly people don't
see it, but look, when a storm comes there are signs before.
That subtle change in the wind, that damning hue forming in
the sky.

To avoid disaster you have to catch things early! That's how
you move through life smoothly, that's how you move through
life sideways.

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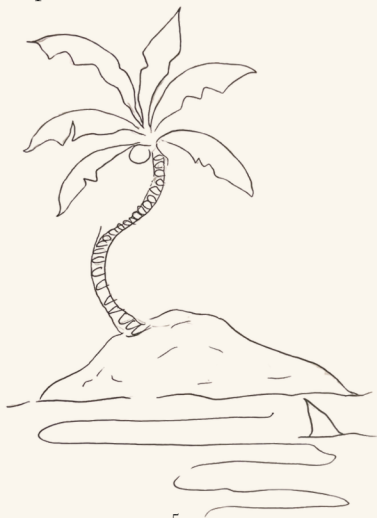
So how will it end?

Well, rarely, once in a while I realise that, well, I haven't lived at
all!

I'd ask you why but I know you already, oh you think I'm too
cold but you're mistaken. I feel it all and I can't stand it! All
that gummy softness, that desire, that love. I feel it all, don't
you think I'm cold!

All the men I've known have sung that same exact song! Truth
be told, they would have run a muck if they truly knew all of
me. But luckily I hide, I burrow, I protect myself in my own
womb like a fetus. A great ocean between them and I.

They say we can't be islands, well here I stand, untouched
(untruly) island of a woman! Yes, say what you like yet here I
stand. Despite it all, I am the island that was and is!



Yes I love to dream! Oh I dream so much you'd feel sorry for me. A crab with her head in the clouds. Wow, well then I feel human—I transform into your damsel, a princess, soft curls down my back, a linen shift.

Breathable.

Then to suddenly be roused back to reality, to the monotony of it all. The clock really does tick so slowly here, dear reader. Yet it all seemed to happen so quickly. This transformation, one day I just looked down and there I was, all shell. From skipping to scuttling, from hugging to pinching.

Well, where to now!?

When a salty tear runs down my shell it scars my cheeks. It burns this home I've made for myself! Oh it stings for days on end.

You can't bite, so won't you? Won't you let me show you there's life in me yet? Before it gets too late, I would love to show a talent of mine. I am desperate you see, and now you know me not to be as cruel as I once seemed.

Far from it, my heart overflows and I want to do a million things in this one life of mine. But nothing seems to be in the cards for me! I've long asked God to show me his hand.

Nothing, nothing.



Now it's time. It's the dead of night, and here we are, my dear reader, thank you.

Here it is! Not only do I dream alone but I dance! I knew you wouldn't think me odd, you can see I'm nothing to be afraid of!

Let's begin!

Watch me, as I show you the freedom to be gained in this skeletal exterior of mine, look at my feet as they move to the great invisible rhythm, my pincers! Wands— So a crab can't dance? But look!

How I move! In line with everything, how I can dance and dance. Even in this darkness! Even with that tide coming in! Even with a goodbye coming closer.

Yes, keep me in your sight! Even! Yes, even! As my feet stumble, yes! Even! As the sand gets in my eye, yes! Even! As the blood rushes to my ears, to my curls, my chest heaves, my legs crack, oh wow!

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THE END

'So now what's love to a crab?
A crab like me? With pincers like mine?'